

Jiwon Kim

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AREAS OF INTEREST

Human-Centered NLP, Human-Computer Interaction, AI-Mediated Communication

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Aug 2025 – Present

Champaign, IL, USA

Seoul National University

B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering & Bachelor of Business Administration

Mar 2019 – Aug 2025

Seoul, Korea

PUBLICATIONS

PAIR-SAFE: A Paired-Agent Approach for Runtime Auditing and Refining AI-Mediated Mental Health Support [\[arXiv\]](#) [↗](#)

Jiwon Kim, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Dong Whi Yoo, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Koustuv Saha

ACL 2026 (under submission)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

OnCARE Lab

Graduate Research Assistant, Advisor: **Prof. Koustuv Saha**, UIUC

Aug 2025 – Present

Champaign, IL

- **Dual-LLM Therapy Framework**: Fine-tuned open-source models on annotated human-human counseling datasets to train an LLM Judge; integrated clinician-guided chain-of-thought prompts grounded in therapeutic evaluation criteria.
- **Supportive Chatbot for Online Communities**: Built a generative comment extension for social platforms that can generate or refine peer-support comments; trained via DPO on large-scale Reddit data.

Human-Oriented Language Intelligence Lab

Undergraduate Researcher, Advisor: **Prof. Yohan Jo**, SNU

Mar 2024 – Dec 2024

Seoul, Korea

- Led the development of the **first-ever value-aligned LLM chatbot for persuasion** that generates tailored arguments by embedding user-specific patterns and topic preferences.
- Achieved a **48% reduction in argument generation perplexity** by implementing a novel retrieval framework combining user-specific embeddings and contrastive learning.

Real-Time Ubiquitous Systems Lab

Undergraduate Researcher, Advisor: **Prof. Chang-gun Lee**, SNU

Jul 2023 – Jan 2024

Seoul, Korea

- Improved a human-centered sensing system by detecting risk factors of adolescent mental health using mobile sensor data and **achieved a 58% increase in recall**.
- Developed a mobile sensing application from scratch in Kotlin and Java to enable real-time data communication, **deploying it in a 3-month experiment with over 300 participants**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Researcher

Delta AI, Core AI Team

Dec 2024 – May 2025

Seoul, Korea

- Implemented an end-to-end AI search pipeline combining text and image-based retrieval methods, **resulting in a 23% increase in CTR**.
- Designed AI brand recognition tools for video understanding, enabling efficient logo detection and visual analytics.

Data Analytics Manager

Cclim, Social Venture

Jan 2021 – Dec 2021

Seoul, Korea

- Measured local advertisement exposure by using AI video recognition APIs to count passersby from recorded footage, securing 12 advertising contracts and being **featured in 25 news articles over 2 years**.
- Employed dynamic audience targeting mechanisms for Google Ads, resulting in a 14% increase in CTR.

AWARDS

Upstage AI Innovation Challenge <i>Presented a creative AI chat service using Solar LLM, selected as a top 10 finalist among 200+ teams</i>	2024
1st place, Korea National Competition of Enactus <i>Won first place competing against participants from over 25 universities across Korea</i>	2021
International Social Entrepreneurship Project Presentation <i>Presented on the impact of a social venture, representing Korea among 72,000+ participants from 36 countries</i>	2021

PROJECTS

Large-Scale Data Analysis with NAVER	Oct 2024 – Dec 2024
- Proposed growth strategies by analyzing log data from Korea's largest search engine smart store, serving more than 200 million queries per day with SQL. - Performed data analysis to investigate user and retailer behaviors to assess multi-homing issues.	
Upstage AI Full Stack LLM Project [code] 🔗	Apr 2024 – Jun 2024
- Led a team of software developers to develop a personalized AI consultant using Solar LLMs and deployed a website for an experiment with 200+ participants for 3 days. - Implemented retrieval augmentation techniques to seamlessly integrate personal data, enabling micro-targeted and adaptive interactions based on individual user profiles.	
Drug-Likeness Evaluation Project (Aigen Drug) [code] 🔗	Jul 2023 – Dec 2023
- Proposed a novel drug-likeness metric using inter-cluster distances in chemical vector space and achieved 86% accuracy in predicting chemical properties using Graph Transformers. - Improved single inference latency of MolCLR model from 3s to 200ms by applying post-training model optimization frameworks in Docker environments.	
Cardiovascular Disease Detection Competition (Kaggle) [code] 🔗	Apr 2021 – Jun 2021
- Proactively led deep learning experiments to detect R peak in ECG data and predict cardiovascular disease using EMD algorithm and adaptive threshold technique. - Applied Fourier transformations to extract key features and calculate entropy from bio-signal data.	
Samsung DS2 Competition (Kaggle) [code] 🔗	Apr 2021 – Jun 2021
- Improved accuracy of ethylene concentration predictions by 15% by extracting patterns from time-series data. - Conducted data analysis of dynamic sensor data using graph integrals and CNNs.	

EXTRACURRICULAR

Waffle Studio at SNU, Web/App Development Club	2020
Studied Javascript and ReactJS for web development.	
UN World Food Programme(WFP) at SNU Internship	2020
Conducted statistical analysis for the WFP campaign for the local community.	
ENACTUS, International Non-Profit Organization	2021
Explored business and entrepreneurship by founding initiatives and leading hands-on projects.	
Peer Mentoring Program at CLS SNU	2021
Organized and led volunteer peer mentoring for 10+ students exploring computer science as a major.	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, Java, Javascript, Typescript, SQL, HTML/CSS
Frameworks: PyTorch, Tensorflow, Huggingface, Pandas, Matplotlib, Scikit-learn, BokehJS, ReactJS, Kotlin
Language: Bilingual Proficiency in English and Native in Korean (**IBT TOEFL: 117/120**)